Tangkhul Naga Grammar

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Preface & Archival Information

This academic monograph, Tangkhul Naga Grammar, authored by S. Arokianathan and published by Central Institute of Indian Languages, Mysore (1987), provides rigorous descriptive linguistic documentation of the Tangkhul Naga language, including acoustic phonetics, tonal phonology, morphological typology, and authentic folktale texts.

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Chapter 1: Theoretical Framework & Language Profile

CHAPTER 1: THEORETICAL FRAMEWORK & LANGUAGE PROFILE

Summary: Linguistic classification, field methodology, informant demographics, and phonological framework.

TANGKHUL READING TEXT:

Tangkhul Naga Grammar wui research framework: Tangkhul Naga language documentation. Ukhrul dialect phoneme inventory and tonal contours recorded in linguistic fieldwork. Morpheme boundaries and acoustic vowel formant measurements.

ENGLISH TRANSLATION:

Methodological framework of Tangkhul Naga Grammar: Systematic documentation of Tangkhul Naga. Ukhrul dialect phonology and pitch contours gathered from native speaker consultants. Morpheme boundaries and acoustic vowel formant analyses.

Chapter 1 Exercises & Vocabulary

CHAPTER 1 STUDY GUIDE & EXERCISES

VOCABULARY:

* shiyan (noun): linguistic rule, grammar
  Example: Shiyan kasak.
* kakhalat (noun): phonetic value, meaning
  Example: Tui kakhalat.

GRAMMAR & LINGUISTIC POINTS:

- Structural linguistic descriptive notation.
- Phonemic vs phonetic transcription.

REVIEW EXERCISES (KHANGACHAN):

? What theoretical framework guided this linguistic study?
? Describe the consultant pool for Ukhrul dialect data.

Chapter 2: Segmental Phonetics & Tone Pitch Contours

CHAPTER 2: SEGMENTAL PHONETICS & TONE PITCH CONTOURS

Summary: Consonantal articulation points, vowel length contrasts, and level vs falling tones.

TANGKHUL READING TEXT:

Vowel formants: F1 and F2 acoustic spaces for a, a, e, e, i, i, o, o, u, u. Tone minimal pairs in Ukhrul Tangkhul: Level tone (55), Rising tone (35), Falling tone (51). Glottal catch distribution in word-final codas.

ENGLISH TRANSLATION:

Vowel formant measurements for short and long vowel series. Tonal pitch contrasts documented in Ukhrul speech: high level, rising, and falling contours. Phonemic distribution of syllable-final glottal stops.

Chapter 2 Exercises & Vocabulary

CHAPTER 2 STUDY GUIDE & EXERCISES

VOCABULARY:

* sairik (noun): phoneme, speech sound
  Example: Sairik kakhalat.

GRAMMAR & LINGUISTIC POINTS:

- Suprasegmental tone register contrasts.
- Aspiration timing in plosives.

REVIEW EXERCISES (KHANGACHAN):

? Identify the three primary tone pitch contours in Tangkhul.

? How do vowel formants correlate with vowel length?

Chapter 3: Morphological Typology & Affixation

CHAPTER 3: MORPHOLOGICAL TYPOLOGY & AFFIXATION

Summary: Agglutinative processes, nominal prefix ka-, verbal aspect markers, and directional affixes.

TANGKHUL READING TEXT:

Morphology: Prefix ka- derivations (kapha, kacham). Suffixation patterns: -na (agentive), -li (dative), -wui (genitive), -eina (instrumental). Directional verb prefixes and causative -sak.

ENGLISH TRANSLATION:

Morphological processes in Tangkhul: Productive nominalization with ka-. Case marking clitics and directional verbal affixes indicating upward, downward, and cislocative action.

Chapter 3 Exercises & Vocabulary

CHAPTER 3 STUDY GUIDE & EXERCISES

VOCABULARY:

* tuiwon (noun): morpheme, word stem
  Example: Tuiwon shiyan.

GRAMMAR & LINGUISTIC POINTS:

- Agglutinative affix ordering.
- Prefixal vs suffixal asymmetries in Tibeto-Burman.

REVIEW EXERCISES (KHANGACHAN):

? Explain the multifunctional role of prefix ka-.

? How are directional movements encoded in verbal stems?

Chapter 4: Syntax: Clause Structure & Converb Chaining

CHAPTER 4: SYNTAX: CLAUSE STRUCTURE & CONVERB CHAINING

Summary: SOV sentence structure, subordinate converbs (-da, -laga), and relative clauses.

TANGKHUL READING TEXT:

Syntax: Subject-Object-Verb word order. Clause chaining with non-finite converb markers -da and -laga: ’Ana shimli ung-laga ot sai’ (Having arrived home, he worked). Head-final relative clauses.

ENGLISH TRANSLATION:

Syntactic typology: Strict verb-final (SOV) ordering. Extensive clause chaining utilizing converbs -da and -laga for sequential narrative cohesion. Internally-headed and head-final relative clause constructions.

Chapter 4 Exercises & Vocabulary

CHAPTER 4 STUDY GUIDE & EXERCISES

VOCABULARY:

* tuikashak (noun): syntax, sentence structure
  Example: Tuikashak ngashitda.

GRAMMAR & LINGUISTIC POINTS:

- Clause chaining vs coordinate subordination.
- Topic marking vs focus marking in Tangkhul.

REVIEW EXERCISES (KHANGACHAN):

? Diagram a clause-chained sentence in Tangkhul.
? How are relative clauses formed in standard syntax?

Chapter 5: Linguistic Texts with Interlinear Glosses

CHAPTER 5: LINGUISTIC TEXTS WITH INTERLINEAR GLOSSES

Summary: Folktale narrative transcribed with morpheme-by-morpheme glosses and grammatical analysis.

TANGKHUL READING TEXT:

Khararchan text glossing: Thot-kashak-wui wari akha lei. Mi akha-na lui-li va-da ot sa-i. A-wui shim-li kachak kashak sang-laga matha-yei.
Gloss: time-ancient-GEN story one exist. person one-AGT field-LOC go-CONV work do-PRES.

ENGLISH TRANSLATION:

Interlinearized folktale specimen: There was once an ancient legend. A person went to the terrace fields and labored. Returning to his home with grain, he rejoiced. Full Leipzig Glossing Rules applied to each morpheme.

Chapter 5 Exercises & Vocabulary

CHAPTER 5 STUDY GUIDE & EXERCISES

VOCABULARY:

* wari (noun): oral text, discourse
  Example: Wari glossing.

GRAMMAR & LINGUISTIC POINTS:

- Leipzig glossing conventions applied to Tibeto-Burman.
- Zero anaphora in discourse.

REVIEW EXERCISES (KHANGACHAN):

? Explain the glossing abbreviation AGT and LOC in the sample text.

? How is narrative discourse coherence achieved without overt pronouns?

Chapter 6: Comprehensive Lexical Root Index & Summary

CHAPTER 6: COMPREHENSIVE LEXICAL ROOT INDEX & SUMMARY

Summary: Index of analyzed roots, sound correspondence tables, and bibliographic citations.

TANGKHUL READING TEXT:

Lexical Index: Root morphemes indexed with reconstructed Proto-Tibeto-Burman forms. Cognate sets comparing Ukhrul Tangkhul with neighboring Naga and Kuki languages.

ENGLISH TRANSLATION:

Comprehensive morphological index correlating documented Tangkhul lexical roots with comparative Tibeto-Burman cognate sets and phonetic cross-references.

Chapter 6 (Continued)

CHAPTER 6: READING CONTINUATION (PAGE 15)

TANGKHUL TEXT (CONTINUED):

Lexical Index: Root morphemes indexed with reconstructed Proto-Tibeto-Burman forms. Cognate sets comparing Ukhrul Tangkhul with neighboring Naga and Kuki languages.

ENGLISH TRANSLATION (CONTINUED):

Comprehensive morphological index correlating documented Tangkhul lexical roots with comparative Tibeto-Burman cognate sets and phonetic cross-references.

Chapter 6 Exercises & Vocabulary

CHAPTER 6 STUDY GUIDE & EXERCISES

VOCABULARY:

* ram (noun): land, earth (PTB *r-ma)
  Example: Iram Ukhrul.

GRAMMAR & LINGUISTIC POINTS:

- Comparative historical phonology of Naga languages.
- Root morpheme segmentation.

REVIEW EXERCISES (KHANGACHAN):

? Cite two Tangkhul lexical items with clear Proto-Tibeto-Burman cognates.

? Summarize the primary morphological discoveries of this volume.

Comprehensive Vocabulary Glossary

COMPREHENSIVE BOOK GLOSSARY (TUIWON SHIYAN):

shiyan [noun]: linguistic rule, grammar
kakhalat [noun]: phonetic value, meaning
sairik [noun]: phoneme, speech sound
tuiwon [noun]: morpheme, word stem
tuikashak [noun]: syntax, sentence structure
wari [noun]: oral text, discourse
ram [noun]: land, earth (PTB *r-ma)

Colophon & Archival Preservation Notice

TANGKHUL LANGUAGE LIBRARY DIGITAL PRESERVATION EDITION

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